

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Brain and Cognitive Sciences (BCS); Collective Cognition Lab	2021-present
	University of Rochester, New York	
MS(R)	Cognitive Science (CGS); Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur (CGPA: 9.35/10)	2018-21
B.Sc.	Physics; Amrita University, Coimbatore, India (CGPA: 9.66/10)	2015-18

CURRENT RESEARCH

Experimental emergence of conventions in humans	2021 - present
Studying the emergence of conventions under various conditions through computerized multiplayer tasks with humans to address questions that advances our understanding of how groups solve recurring multi-agent coordination problems	
Coordinated problem solving in marmoset monkeys (<i>Callithrix jacchus</i>)	2021 - present
Developing a paradigm to study the cognitive mechanisms underlying coordinated problem-solving in a physically intuitive task with a cooperatively breeding primate	
Gaze following in marmoset monkeys (<i>Callithrix jacchus</i>)	2021 – present
Studying gaze-following (directing one's attention to where someone else is looking, essential for successful social interaction involving coordination) in common marmoset monkeys (<i>Callithrix jacchus</i>) to address questions about the evolution of this ability in humans using naturalistic video stimuli and high-precision eye tracking	

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Best Graduate Student Talk Award	April 2026
<i>33rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition</i>	
Edward Peck Curtis Teaching Award	April 2026
<i>University of Rochester</i>	
Open Scholarship Award	April 2026
<i>University of Rochester</i>	
3 Minute Thesis Runner-Up	December 2025
<i>University of Rochester</i>	
Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute Fellow	July 2025
<i>University of St. Andrews, Scotland</i>	
Kuczaj Memorial Travel Grant	March 2025
<i>32nd International Conference on Comparative Cognition</i>	
Donald M. and Janet C. Barnard Fellow.	2024-25
<i>Awarded by the School of Arts, Sciences & Engineering at the University of Rochester, in recognition of achievements in research, mentoring, outreach and service.</i>	
Best Research Talk	October 2023
<i>Graduate Research Day, University of Rochester</i>	

MANUSCRIPTS

Mohan, O., & Biro, D. (in press). Experimental Emergence of Conventions in Human Dyads. <i>PLOS ONE</i>.
Mohan, O., *Nelms, A., Bucklaew, A., Biro, D., & Mitchell, J. F. (2025). Probing the limited oculomotor range of common marmosets (<i>Callithrix jacchus</i>). <i>bioRxiv</i>, 2025-11.
* Undergraduate mentee

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

<i>Independently learned behavioral strategies support coordination in common marmosets</i>	
Oviya Mohan, Janejira Chapoomee, and Dora Biro	
Poster, 48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society	July 2026
<i>Common marmosets exhibit coordination in a rope-pulling task</i>	
Oviya Mohan, Jude Mitchell and Dora Biro	
Talk, 33rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition	April 2026
<i>Context-dependent gaze following in common marmosets</i>	
Oviya Mohan, Dora Biro and Jude Mitchell	
Poster, 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society	August 2025
Poster, 25th Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society [Proceedings]	May 2025

Experimental Emergence of Conventions in Humans

Oviya Mohan and Dora Biro

Poster, 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society [[Proceedings](#)]

July 2024

Talk, 31st International Conference on Comparative Cognition

April 2024

Poster, Gordon Research Conference - Collective Behavior

August 2023

Free-viewing of static natural images and movies in marmoset monkeys

Oviya Mohan, Amy Bucklaew, Dora Biro, and Jude F. Mitchell

Poster, 24th Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society [[Proceedings](#)]

May 2024

Presented by undergraduate mentees:

Cognition Gone Wild: Exploring the present and future of Machine Learning methods to study

Primate Cognition

Federico Sánchez Vargas, Sai Rakshith Potluri, **Oviya Mohan**, Dora Biro, & Marcela Benítez

Poster, Southeastern Evolution and Human Behavior Conference

September 2025

Context-Dependent Vocal Behavior in Common Marmosets

Cecilia Zhu, **Oviya Mohan**, Janejira Chapoomee, Jude Mitchell, and Dora Biro

Poster, University of Rochester Undergraduate Research Exposition

July 2025

Application and Evaluation of DeepLabCut Multi-animal Network

Janejira Chapoomee, **Oviya Mohan**, Dora Biro, and Jude Mitchell

Poster, University of Rochester Undergraduate Research Exposition

July 2023

Evaluation of DeepLabCut multi-animal labeling in novel social foraging paradigm

Helena Xiong, **Oviya Mohan**, Luke Shaw, Dora Biro, and Jude Mitchell

Poster, University of Rochester Undergraduate Research Exposition

July 2022

Presented by high school mentees:

Probability Matching in Ants

Gypsy Malave, Sophia Liu, **Oviya Mohan**, Rithwik Cherian, Takao Sasaki

Poster, NeURoEast Research Exposition

July 2025

Quantifying Personality in Marmosets

Dianileez Flores, Rithwik Cherian, **Oviya Mohan**, and Dora Biro

Poster, NeURoEast Research Exposition

July 2024

TEACHING

Co-Instructor, Animal Minds (BCSC 183)

Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, Computational Models of Perception and Cognition (BCSC 229)

Spring 2025

Guest Lecture, Language Use and Understanding (BCSC 261)

Fall 2024, 2025

Teaching Assistant, Animal Minds (BCSC 183)

Fall 2022, 2023

Organizer/Instructor, Advanced Methods in Brain and Cognitive Sciences (BCSC 509)

Spring 2023

Organizer/Instructor, Statistics for Brain and Cognitive Sciences (BCSC 519)

Fall 2022

Tutor, Basic Statistics, Data Analysis and Inference (CGS 602A)

Fall 2020

Teaching Assistant, Logic and Cognitive Science (CGS 651A)

Spring 2020

PAST RESEARCH

Master's Thesis, *Executive Function and Reasoning*

2019-21

Designed and conducted experiments, using rules of formal logic, to understand the connection between executive functions and reasoning in different developmental stages, including school children

Master's Project, *Agent Based Modelling of Cooperation*

2019

Used an agent-based model to better understand the role of cooperation in the survival of both individuals and groups in a community

Bachelor's Project, *Pulse Generating Circuit for NMR (for an indigenous MRI)*

2018

Advisor: Dr. Murugadass K, Amrita University

Built a pulse generating circuit for NMR using 555 timer IC for building an indigenous MRI machine

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Research Associate, *Building a GUI for PHMR, GAIL*

2021

Applied Dynamics and Vibration Laboratory, Dept. of Mechanical Engineering, IIT Kanpur

Designed an intuitive GUI to display data from a gas pipeline health monitoring robot (PHMR), for a project commissioned by the Gas Authority of India Ltd. (GAIL)

Research Assistant, *Role of Object's Self Relevance in Attentional Guidance*

2018-19

Designed and conducted behavioral experiments to understand the role of an object's self-relevance when used as a distractor in visual search paradigms

Research Internship, Tribological Characterization and Coating Deposition

2017

Defence Research & Development Organization, Hyderabad

Utilized a tribometer to characterize frictional properties of various coatings

MENTORING AND LEADERSHIP

Undergraduate Mentees:	2023 - present
Janejira Chapoomee (Neuroscience), Alexia Nelms (Neuroscience), Yiran Zhu (Brain & Cognitive Sciences)	
Past: Enana Jacob (Neuroscience), Kiet Nguyen (Computer Science), Skye Crocker (Data Science), Federico Sanchez (Biology), Helena Xiong (Neuroscience)	
Graduate Student Representative, BCS, University of Rochester	2022-24
Committees: Graduate Program Overhaul, Faculty Search, BCS DEI	
Department Representative, GSA, University of Rochester	2023-24
Graduate Ambassador, GEPA, University of Rochester	2022-23
Hall Executive Committee, IIT Kanpur	2019-20
Core Member, Association of Sciences, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham	2016-18
School Pupil Leader, The PSBB Millennium School	2014-15

OUTREACH

STAR (Science Teaching through Art), Organizer and Presenter	Fall 2025
DEI (Diversity, Equity and Inclusion) Committee (BCS) - Outreach Coordinator	2023 - 2025
NeURoEast Bench Mentor (mentoring a high school student in a summer project)	Summer 2024, 2025
Brain Awareness Campaign, Volunteer	2023 - 24
Habitat for Humanity, Volunteer	2022
eVidyaloka, Content Developer	2020-21
Created lesson plans to teach children in rural India via local television channels in regional languages	
NSS – National Service Scheme, Amrita University, Volunteer & Unit Secretary (Amrita University)	2016-18
Executed projects renovating village schools, lake clean-ups, tree plantation and road safety drives	

CERTIFICATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

Deep Learning - Machine Vision - Neuromatch Academy	July 2023
Writing about Science for Non-Scientific Audiences - IISER, Pune	December 2020
Introductory Machine Learning Workshop - Indian Institute of Technology, Madras	October 2020
Winter School on Cognitive Modelling - Indian Institute of Technology, Mandi	February 2019
Natural Language Processing - Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur	December 2018

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Programming: Python, R, MATLAB, jsPsych, PsychoPy, C, C++

Other: Public speaking and debate, Voice acting, Student organization and leadership

Languages: Native/Bilingual Proficiency: **English, Tamil**; Goethe-Zertifikat A1: **German**; DELF A2: **French**